



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	8 th March 2022	Time of Incident:	14:00hrs
Region / Directorate:	Great Southern Region	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number:	26235
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Worker observed sitting on front step of Stabilizer when travelling
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Executive Summary:

At approximately 14:00hrs on the 8th of March 2022 a stabiliser crew member conducting moisture control was observed sitting on the top of the front steps of a stabiliser machine while it was travelling to a new location. A call was immediately placed to the principal contractors Senior Supervisor who attended site and stopped the works.

A passenger seat with seat belt was provided in the stabilizer cab for a passenger but was not used. A vehicle was also available for transporting workers within the site, this was not within the area of the works at the time the stabilizer commenced travelling. All warning decals on the stabiliser were in good condition, including warnings for not accessing / riding on the plant when moving at the location the worker was sitting.

The site was 5.5km long and had two supervisors to manage all areas, including offsite borrow pits, etc. The contractor Foreman was new to the site and had only been onsite for six days at the time of the incident

The stabilizer operator had been onsite for 5 days and had completed training and a VOC on the stabilizer involved, the Sub-Contractors internal training and VOC was mapped against the training requirements of RIICRC309E Conduct Stabiliser Operations. The moisture control worker was young (<20) and been working in the role for 4-5 weeks. Both workers involved did not perceive the hazard of riding on the machine to be prohibitive.

Incident Photos:



Location of worker sitting. Warning decals clearly visible



Warning decals



Stabilizer

Contributing Factors:

- No review of the Sub-Contractors SWMS for the stabilisation works was conducted by the principal contractor
- Sub-Contractor had a VOC for the stabilizer, this did not cover specific information as to use of passenger seat and seat belt.
- Sub-Contractor Foreman was not in the vicinity of the event at the time, had only been onsite for six days prior
- There were two supervisors covering a 5.5km site, including access roads and borrow pits

Corrective Actions:

- Review of relevant Sub-Contractors SWMS and risk assessment
- Additional Leading Hand to be included to provide support and help to the project team
- Review and update project CRAW, Site induction and Safety Management Plan

Additional Issues/Learnings:

- Where Young or inexperienced workers are present, interactions should include discussions on job steps and transport arrangements on large sites.
- Importance of site inspections, leadership interactions and audits in ensuring workers understand site rules and company procedures
- Improvements required to risk assessments to capture similar scenarios and presentation of these in inductions



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Mobile Plant.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations